ascentium

Startup toolkit

Philippines

Setting up and running a domestic corporation in the Philippines.

Inside: the company at a glance · your first 90 days · the annual compliance calendar · are you an SME? · the documents to gather · how Ascentium helps

Mock toolkit prepared for a concept prototype. Not legal, tax or financial advice.
Information as at November 2026. Verify figures with the relevant authority before relying on them.

1. Your company at a glance

Item	What applies
Entity	Domestic stock corporation (one-person corporations are also available)
Registry	Securities and Exchange Commission (SEC)
Tax registration	Bureau of Internal Revenue (BIR)
Foreign ownership	Open for most activities; foreign-owned companies selling domestically face minimum paid-in capital rules
Corporate tax	25% standard; 20% for companies with net taxable income up to PHP 5 million and assets up to PHP 100 million
Local permits	Barangay clearance and mayor's permit from the city where you operate

2. Your first 90 days

Tick these off in order. Your Ascentium dashboard tracks each one and Ascentia will remind you before anything falls due.

- ☐ **Reserve the name and register with the SEC**
  File articles of incorporation and by-laws online.
- ☐ **Obtain local permits**
  Barangay clearance and the mayor's business permit.
- ☐ **Register with the BIR**
  Receive your certificate of registration and register books and invoices.
- ☐ **Open a bank account**
  Deposit the paid-in capital.
- ☐ **Hiring?**
  Register with SSS, PhilHealth and Pag-IBIG.
- ☐ **Hold the organisational meeting**
  Then file the General Information Sheet.

3. Annual compliance calendar

The recurring obligations most small private companies meet each year. Exact dates depend on your financial year-end and on notices issued by the authorities.

Obligation	When	Authority
General Information Sheet	Within 30 days of the annual meeting	SEC
Quarterly income tax returns	60 days after each quarter	BIR
Annual income tax return	15 April for calendar-year companies	BIR
Audited financial statements	With the annual return, and filed with the SEC on its schedule	BIR and SEC
Business permit renewal	By 20 January each year	City or municipality

4. Are you an SME?

Under the Magna Carta for MSMEs, a medium enterprise has total assets (excluding land) of more than PHP 15 million up to PHP 100 million. The statistics authority also counts 100 to 199 employees as medium.

Ascentium SME pricing

If your company, assessed together with any linked group companies, meets the official SME definition above, you qualify for Ascentium SME fares and the AI platform. Larger groups are served by Ascentium for Enterprise at ascentium.com.

5. Documents to gather

- ☐ **Passport or government ID for every incorporator and director**
- ☐ **Proposed company name (with alternatives)**
- ☐ **Articles of incorporation and by-laws**
- ☐ **Proof of inward remittance for foreign capital**
- ☐ **Registered office lease**

6. How Ascentium helps

AI compliance dashboard	A live compliance score for every entity, with each filing, deadline and document in one view.
Ascentia, AI voice assistant	Ask about your status, deadlines or a change, 24/7, and get a qualified expert when judgement is needed.
Premium Economy fare	SEC and BIR registration, local permits, bookkeeping and the annual income tax return from PHP 119,000 a year.
Switching is easy	Moving from another provider? We take over registers and records and file the change for you.